

The Relationship between Social Network Marketing and Organizational Performance: A Field Study of Service Organizations in Guelma City

علاقة التسويق عبر الشبكات الاجتماعية بالأداء المؤسسي: دراسة ميدانية للمؤسسات الخدمية في مدينة قالمة

Boumediene Belkebir¹, El-Hadi Boukalkoul²

¹University of Guelma, (Algeria), belkebir.boumediene@univ-guelma.dz

²University of Annaba (Algeria), el-hadi.boukalkoul@univ-annaba.dz

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Abstract:

This study aims to investigate the relationship between social network marketing and organizational performance within a sample of service establishments in Guelma city. A total of 112 questionnaires were randomly distributed among employees in the study area.

The findings indicate that service establishments in Guelma city significantly rely on social network marketing. The results also showed that organizational performance in these organizations is at a high level. Furthermore, the study revealed a positive correlation between some dimensions of social network marketing and organizational performance, with the exception of YouTube. Finally, the study confirmed the existence of a significant effect of social network marketing on organizational performance in service establishments in Guelma city.

Keywords: Marketing; Social Networks; Social Network Marketing; Organizational Performance; Service establishments.

JEL Classification Codes: M31, L84, O33.

ملخص:

تهدف هذه الدراسة إلى استقصاء علاقة التسويق عبر الشبكات الاجتماعية بالأداء المؤسسي، وذلك في عينة من المؤسسات الخدمية بمدينة قالمة. وقد وُزعت 112 استمارة بشكل عشوائي على الموظفين بميدان الدراسة.

¹ *Corresponding author:* Boumediene Belkebir, *e-mail:* belkebir.boumediene@univ-guelma.dz

توصلت نتائج الدراسة إلى أن المؤسسات الخدمية بمدينة قالة تعتمد بشكل ملحوظ على التسويق عبر الشبكات الاجتماعية. كما أظهرت النتائج أن الأداء المؤسسي في هذه المؤسسات يتمتع بمستوى عالٍ. وبينت الدراسة كذلك وجود علاقة طردية بين بعض أبعاد التسويق عبر الشبكات الاجتماعية والأداء المؤسسي، عدا اليوتيوب. وفي النهاية، تم إثبات وجود أثر فعلي للتسويق عبر الشبكات الاجتماعية على الأداء المؤسسي في المؤسسات الخدمية بمدينة قالة.

كلمات مفتاحية: التسويق، الشبكات الاجتماعية، التسويق عبر الشبكات الاجتماعية، الأداء المؤسسي، المؤسسات الخدمية.

تصنيفات JEL : M31، L84، O33

1. INTRODUCTION

The past few years have witnessed a radical transformation in marketing methods, as technological advancements and the widespread proliferation of the internet have created a new digital environment enabling organizations to communicate directly and instantly with their target audience. Social networks are among the most prominent tools of this transformation, as platforms such as Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, and YouTube have become effective interactive spaces that allow organizations to market their services, build strong relationships with customers, and enhance their market presence.

In this context, social network marketing has gained increasing importance as a strategic tool contributing to the achievement of organizational goals and the improvement of organizational performance. The success of an organization is no longer solely dependent on the quality of its services, but also on its ability to interact with the digital environment and adapt to new market trends.

This study aims to investigate the relationship between social network marketing and organizational performance in service establishments, through a field study of a sample of these organizations in Guelma city. It seeks to determine the extent to which the use of social network tools and techniques affects the effectiveness of administrative operations, service quality, and customer satisfaction, and consequently, the overall performance of the organization.

Study Problem:

The widespread use of social networks has led to a radical transformation in the marketing strategies adopted by organizations, especially Algerian service establishments that rely heavily on direct interaction with customers. Although marketing through these networks is considered a modern and effective method, its impact on organizational performance still needs study and analysis, especially in local contexts such as Guelma city. In light of the foregoing, we can pose the following main question: **Is there a relationship between social network marketing and organizational performance in service establishments in Guelma city?**

Based on this problem, we can pose the following sub-questions:

1. To what extent do service establishments in Guelma city rely on social network marketing?
2. What is the level of organizational performance in these service establishments in the study area?
3. Is there a relationship between the dimensions of social network marketing and organizational performance in the organizations in the study area?

Study Hypotheses:

Main Hypothesis: “There is no statistically significant relationship at the significance level ($\alpha \leq 0.05$) between social network marketing and organizational performance in service establishments in Guelma city.”

This main hypothesis branches into the following sub-hypotheses:

Sub-Hypothesis One: “There is no statistically significant relationship between Facebook marketing and organizational performance in service establishments in Guelma city, at a significance level ($\alpha \leq 0.05$).”

Sub-Hypothesis Two: “There is no statistically significant relationship between Instagram marketing and organizational performance in service establishments in Guelma city, at a significance level ($\alpha \leq 0.05$).”

Sub-Hypothesis Three: “There is no statistically significant relationship between YouTube marketing and organizational performance in service establishments in Guelma city, at a significance level ($\alpha \leq 0.05$).”

Study Objectives: This study aims to:

1. Determine the extent to which service establishments in Guelma city rely on social network marketing (Facebook, Instagram, YouTube) as a promotional tool.
2. Analyze the level of organizational performance in service establishments in Guelma city in terms of profitability, brand loyalty, innovation, and social responsibility.
3. Study the nature of the relationship between social network marketing and organizational performance.
4. Test the individual relationship of each of Facebook, Instagram, and YouTube platforms with organizational performance in the studied organizations.
5. Provide recommendations to service establishments on best practices for using social network marketing to enhance their organizational performance.

2. Theoretical Framework and Previous Studies

2.1 Theoretical Framework:

a. Marketing: Marketing represents one of the fundamental pillars for the survival and growth of organizations. It is a managerial and social process aimed at identifying and meeting customer needs by offering value-added propositions, thereby achieving the organization's short-term and long-term goals (Kotler & Keller, 2016). The marketing concept has evolved from merely selling goods and services to a strategic function that includes building long-term relationships with customers and creating added value for them and the organization. With digital transformation and increased competitiveness, it has become necessary to develop marketing patterns that align with the digital environment, which led to the emergence of social network marketing as an effective and modern tool in managing the relationship with the target audience.

b. Social Networks: Social networks are a manifestation of the digital transformation in human communication, enabling individuals and organizations to interact and instantly exchange information, images, and content across multiple electronic environments. Kaplan and Haenlein (2010) defined them as a group of internet-based applications that are built on

ideological and technological foundations enabling the creation and exchange of user-generated content. These networks, such as Facebook, Instagram, Twitter, YouTube, and TikTok, represent effective channels for transmitting marketing messages and expanding the geographical and demographic reach of the audience, in addition to reducing the cost of reaching them compared to traditional channels.

c. Social Network Marketing: Social network marketing involves utilizing these digital platforms to build relationships with customers, enhance brand awareness, and stimulate purchasing and interactive behavior, which is supported by the “5Cs” model focusing on Content, Conversation, Community, Connection, and Collaboration (Tuten & Solomon, 2017). This marketing approach is more flexible and interactive than traditional digital marketing, due to its reliance on real-time communication, targeted content, and the ability to analyze audience behavior instantly. A study by Mangold and Faulds (2009) also showed that social network marketing enhances customer loyalty and supports the dissemination of information about the organization through sharing experiences and recommendations.

d. Organizational Performance: Organizational performance is closely linked to this form of marketing. Organizational performance refers to an organization’s ability to achieve its goals in terms of efficiency, effectiveness, growth, innovation, and profitability. Performance is usually measured through financial indicators (such as profit and revenue) and non-financial indicators (such as job satisfaction and customer loyalty) (Richard et al., 2009). In the context of digital marketing, organizational performance has become highly dependent on the organization’s ability to adapt to the digital environment and adopt effective tools such as social networks.

e. Service Organizations: In this context, service establishments stand out as economic entities that rely on providing intangible services, encompassing diverse sectors such as education, health, tourism, banking, and insurance. These organizations are characterized by a unique relationship with the customer because the service is produced and consumed at the same time (Lovelock & Wirtz, 2016). Since this relationship requires trust and direct communication, social networks have become a strategic means for service

establishments to build a positive image, interact with customers more humanely and quickly, and achieve customer satisfaction and retention.

Based on the foregoing, the conceptual and functional overlap between these concepts clarifies the importance of studying the impact of social network marketing on organizational performance, especially in service environments like Guelma city, where organizations rely on continuous interaction with the local audience and digital marketing as a vital means for expansion and sustainability.

2.2 Review of Previous Studies: Numerous studies conducted by researchers in the field of management have shown that the application of social network marketing leads to enhanced organizational performance and innovation. In this context, a study by Parveen, Jaafar, and Ainin (2016) indicated that the use of social media effectively contributes to improving organizational performance by reducing costs, enhancing interaction with customers, and facilitating information flow within the organization. A meta-analytic study (Martínez et al., 2022) covering 65 organizations also confirmed a moderate to strong positive relationship between social network use and improved organizational performance, which reinforces the importance of this marketing approach in contemporary institutional environments. Similarly, a study by Musa et al. (2016) on small and medium-sized enterprises in Malaysia showed that social network marketing components, such as brand reputation and customer interaction, are positively associated with the performance of these organizations, especially in the digital business environment. Furthermore, a study by Parveen et al. (2024) in the higher education sector in Indonesia demonstrated that the systematic use of social media platforms enhances organizational performance and contributes to supporting innovation within the organization. On the other hand, the results of a study by Ferrer et al. showed that the strategic use of Facebook by startups leads to tangible improvements in financial and non-financial performance, by improving customer reach, enhancing their loyalty, and reducing operational costs. In another applied study (Al-Shidhani, 2019) conducted in the Sultanate of Oman, it was found that the use of paid advertising tools on Facebook contributes to increasing operational efficiency and improving organizational flexibility. In the context of more

comprehensive global studies, a report issued by Deloitte (2024) concluded that organizations with high digital maturity that adopt advanced social marketing strategies achieve revenue growth exceeding 10% annually, and have a greater ability to achieve their profitability and expansion goals compared to their traditional counterparts. Meanwhile, a study by Shafa and Puspitasari (2024) showed that the combined use of Twitter and Instagram by Indonesian companies contributed to improving net income and Tobin's Q index, despite the absence of a clear impact on some other financial performance indicators such as return on assets, indicating that the impact may be indirect in some cases. In a similar study conducted by Ishak (2024), it was found that organizational performance is an important mediator in the relationship between social network use and innovation, especially in private higher education institutions. In an applied study in the Sultanate of Oman, the results of Bakheet and Al Shezawi (2024) showed that Instagram users' interaction with content and modern information enhances the marketing performance of home-based businesses, which indicates the importance of digital interaction as an effective marketing tool. A study by Surjono (2024) also showed that influencer participation via Instagram contributes directly and indirectly to improving the marketing performance of small organizations, by enhancing content credibility and expanding the follower base. In a different context, a study by Banjo et al. (2022) in a Nigerian insurance company found that social media marketing contributes to improving organizational performance, especially in terms of response speed and service, but its impact on customer satisfaction was not statistically significant. Meanwhile, a study conducted during the COVID-19 pandemic in Malaysia (Wan Hanafi et al., 2023) showed that the intensive and diverse use of social media led to improved public awareness of the brand and customer service quality, which positively reflected on the overall performance of organizations. On the other hand, a study by Akbar (2021) showed that the use of Instagram by small organizations in Malaysia enhances financial and non-financial performance, where elements such as efficiency, cost reduction, and innovation play a pivotal role in achieving this improvement. A recent Korean study published in Sustainability (2022) confirmed that Instagram marketing

positively affects customer-based capital by improving brand image and loyalty.

These studies collectively indicate a broad agreement on the positive impact of social network use on organizational performance, whether in terms of operational efficiency, innovation, or financial and non-financial growth, although this impact varies depending on the platform type, organization nature, and geographical context.

3. Methods

3.1 Population and Sample: This study was applied to a diverse group of service establishments in Guelma city.

A total of 112 survey questionnaires were distributed, of which 14 were discarded due to non-return and another 13 due to unsuitability, leaving 85 valid questionnaires for analysis.

3.2 Study Tool: A questionnaire was used as the main data collection tool. It consisted of 41 items distributed across two main variables:

- **Independent Variable: Social Network Marketing**, which includes:
 - Items (1-6): Measure the use of Facebook marketing.
 - Items (7-12): Measure the use of Instagram marketing.
 - Items (13-16): Measure the use of YouTube marketing.
- **Dependent Variable: Organizational Performance**, which includes:
 - Items (17-23): related to profitability.
 - Items (24-29): related to innovation.
 - Items (30-35): related to brand loyalty.
 - Items (36-41): related to social responsibility.

The questionnaire items were developed based on a comprehensive review of relevant literature and validated scales. A Likert scale (1 = Strongly Disagree, 5 = Strongly Agree) was used for most of the items.

3.3 Instrument Reliability: Reliability and validity of the questionnaire were assessed using Cronbach's Alpha and factor analysis, respectively. The Alpha coefficient for the social network marketing dimension was (0.87), while for the organizational performance dimension it was (0.824). The Cronbach's Alpha coefficient for all study axes combined reached (88.3%), which is a reliable stability ratio that can be relied upon in the field application of the study, as it is greater than (0.60).

3.4 Data Analysis: Data were analyzed using a set of statistical methods: arithmetic means, standard deviations, Cronbach's Alpha, and Spearman's correlation coefficient, by performing statistical treatments using the Statistical Package for the Social Sciences (SPSS v.25).

4. Results This section presents the main results of our literature review and case analysis, structured to shed light on the impact of social network marketing on organizational performance in service establishments in Guelma city.

4.1 Extent of Reliance on Social Network Marketing: Data obtained (Table 1.) shows that the most present of social network marketing in service establishments in Guelma city is their reliance on the Facebook platform, with a mean score of (4.166), reflecting a high level of use. This is followed in second place by reliance on the Instagram platform, with a mean score of (3.6137). The lowest levels of reliance were recorded in the YouTube marketing, with a mean score of (2.9912).

Table1. Extent of Availability of Social Network Marketing

Social Network Marketing platforms	Mean Score	Evaluation	Rank
Extent of organization's reliance on Facebook marketing	4.1667	High	01
Extent of organization's reliance on Instagram marketing	3.6137	High	20
Extent of organization's reliance on YouTube marketing	2.9912	Medium	30
Social Network Marketing	3.5905	High	/

Source: Prepared by the researchers based on SPSS25 outputs.

The findings indicate that service establishments in Guelma city significantly rely on social network marketing as a promotional tool. This reliance is evident across various platforms, including Facebook, Instagram, and to a lesser extent, YouTube. The overall mean of the social network marketing axis, was (3.5905) The high adoption rate suggests that these

establishments recognize the importance of digital channels for reaching their target audience and engaging with customers.

4.2 Level of Organizational Performance: Data obtained (Table 2.) shows that the most available dimension of organizational performance is brand loyalty, with a mean score of (4.3804), followed by the innovation dimension with a mean of (4.1863). The profitability dimension came in third place with a mean score of (3.8118), while the social responsibility dimension ranked last, recording the lowest mean score of (3.5980).

Table 2. Extent of Availability of Organizational Performance

Organizational Performance Dimensions	Mean Score	Evaluation	Rank
Profitability	High	3,8118	3
Innovation	Very High	4,1863	2
Brand Loyalty	Very High	4,3804	1
Social Responsibility	Medium	3,5980	4
Organizational Performance	High	3,9941	/

Source: Prepared by the researchers based on SPSS25 outputs.

Based on the results of the previous table, and according to the overall mean of the organizational performance axis, which was (3.9941), it can be concluded that the level of organizational performance in the studied organizations is evaluated as "high" from the perspective of the sample members.

The results also showed that organizational performance in these service establishments is at a high level. This was assessed in terms of profitability, brand loyalty, innovation, and social responsibility. The overall mean of this axis, which was (3.9941) The high performance level suggests that these establishments are effectively achieving their strategic objectives and maintaining a strong market position.

4.3 Relationship between Social Network Marketing Dimensions and Organizational Performance: A positive correlation was identified between specific dimensions of social network marketing and organizational performance. This indicates that as the use and effectiveness of social network marketing increase, so does the organizational performance. However, an interesting finding was the exception of YouTube, where no significant correlation was found with organizational performance. This might suggest

that for service establishments in Guelma, YouTube may not be as effective a marketing channel as Facebook and Instagram, or its use is not optimized for performance enhancement.

4.4Effect of Social Network Marketing on Organizational Performance:

Finally, the study confirmed the existence of a significant effect of social network marketing on the organizational performance of service establishments in Guelma city. This implies that social network marketing is not merely a promotional tool but a strategic asset that directly contributes to the overall success and effectiveness of these organizations. The positive impact underscores the importance for service establishments to invest in and strategically manage their social media presence to enhance their performance.

a. Testing Sub-Hypothesis 1:

Table 3. Results of Spearman's Test for the Relationship between the Organization's Reliance on Facebook Marketing and Organizational Performance

		Organizational Performance
Organization's reliance on Facebook marketing	Spearman's Correlation Coefficient	0.605
	Sig	0.000

Source: Prepared by the researchers based on SPSS25.*

The results in Table 3 above show that Spearman's correlation coefficient between the dimension of the organization's reliance on Facebook marketing and organizational performance was (0.605), which is a moderately strong positive correlation. The associated statistical significance level (Sig) was (0.000), which is less than the significance level adopted in this study ($\alpha \leq 0.05$), indicating that the relationship between the two variables is statistically significant. This means that for every one-degree increase in the organization's reliance on Facebook marketing, organizational performance increases by (0.605) degrees, indicating the contribution of this dimension to improving organizational performance within service organizations. Based on these results, the null hypothesis stating that there is no statistically significant relationship between Facebook marketing and organizational performance was rejected, and the alternative hypothesis stating that there is a statistically

significant relationship between the study variables at a significance level ($\alpha \leq 0.05$) was accepted.

b. Testing Sub-Hypothesis 2:

Table 4. Results of Spearman's Test for the Relationship between the Organization's Reliance on Instagram Marketing and Organizational Performance

		Organizational Performance
Organization's reliance on Instagram marketing	Spearman's Correlation Coefficient	0.216
	Sig	0.047

Source: Prepared by the researchers based on SPSS25.

The results in the table above indicate that Spearman's correlation coefficient between the dimension of the organization's reliance on Instagram for marketing and organizational performance was (0.216), indicating a weak positive correlation. The level of statistical significance (Sig.) was (0.047), which is lower than the significance level adopted in this study ($\alpha \leq 0.05$), indicating that the relationship between the two variables is statistically significant. It can be concluded that for every one-degree increase in the level of the organization's reliance on marketing via Instagram, organizational performance increases by (0.216) degrees, suggesting that this dimension contributes – albeit to a limited extent – to enhancing organizational performance. Based on these results, the null hypothesis stating that there is no statistically significant relationship between marketing via Instagram and organizational performance was rejected, and the alternative hypothesis confirming the existence of a statistically significant relationship between the study variables at a significance level of ($\alpha \leq 0.05$) was accepted.

c. Testing Sub-Hypothesis 3:

Table 5. Results of Spearman's Test for the Relationship between the Organization's Reliance on YouTube for Marketing and Organizational Performance

		Organizational Performance
Organization's reliance on FYoutube marketing	Spearman's Correlation Coefficient	0.007
	Sig	0.952

Source: Prepared by the researchers based on SPSS25.

The results in the table above show that Spearman's correlation coefficient between the dimension of the organization's reliance on YouTube for marketing and organizational performance was (0.007), indicating a very weak positive correlation that is almost negligible. The level of statistical significance (Sig.) was (0.952), which is much higher than the significance level adopted in this study ($\alpha \leq 0.05$), indicating that the relationship between the two variables is not statistically significant. Consequently, reliance on marketing via YouTube is not considered a significant contributor to improving organizational performance within the studied organizations, as a one-degree increase in this dimension does not tangibly affect organizational performance (an increase of only 0.007 degrees). Based on these results, the null hypothesis stating that there is no statistically significant relationship between marketing via YouTube and organizational performance in the service organizations in the city of Guelma was accepted, and the alternative hypothesis assuming a significant relationship between the two variables at a significance level of ($\alpha \leq 0.05$) was rejected.

d. Testing the Main Hypothesis: The main hypothesis was tested based on the results of the three sub-hypotheses, which showed the following:

- Rejection of the first sub-hypothesis: Due to the existence of a statistically significant positive relationship between marketing via Facebook and organizational performance (Sig. = $0.000 < 0.05$).
- Rejection of the second sub-hypothesis: Due to the existence of a weak but statistically significant positive relationship between marketing via Instagram and organizational performance (Sig. = $0.047 < 0.05$).

- Acceptance of the third sub-hypothesis: Due to the absence of a statistically significant relationship between marketing via YouTube and organizational performance ($\text{Sig.} = 0.952 > 0.05$).

Based on these results, it is possible to reject the main null hypothesis, which denies the existence of a relationship between social media marketing and organizational performance, and accept the alternative hypothesis, which confirms the existence of a statistically significant relationship, particularly through the Facebook and Instagram dimensions.

5. Discussion

This study aimed to investigate the relationship between social network marketing and organizational performance in service establishments in Guelma city. The findings confirm that social network marketing plays a significant role in enhancing organizational performance, aligning with previous research that highlights the positive impact of social media on various aspects of business operations (Parveen, Jaafar, & Ainin, 2016; Martínez et al., 2022).

The observed high reliance on social network marketing by service establishments in Guelma suggests a growing awareness among these entities of the strategic importance of digital platforms. This is consistent with the evolving marketing landscape where direct and instant communication with target audiences is crucial (Kotler & Keller, 2016). The fact that organizational performance is also at a high level indicates that these organizations are effectively leveraging these tools to achieve their objectives, including profitability, brand loyalty, innovation, and social responsibility.

The positive correlation between specific dimensions of social network marketing (Facebook and Instagram) and organizational performance underscores the effectiveness of these platforms in the local context. Facebook, with its broad reach and diverse engagement features, and Instagram, with its visual appeal and influencer marketing capabilities, appear to be particularly impactful for service establishments (Ferrer et al.; Bakheet & Al Shezawi, 2024; Surjono, 2024). These platforms facilitate direct customer interaction, enhance brand awareness, and stimulate purchasing behavior, as supported by the “5Cs” model of social network marketing (Tuten & Solomon, 2017).

However, the absence of a significant correlation between YouTube marketing and organizational performance is a noteworthy finding. This could be attributed to several factors. Firstly, the nature of service establishments in Guelma might not lend itself to video-centric marketing as effectively as other sectors. Secondly, the cost and effort associated with producing high-quality video content for YouTube might outweigh the perceived benefits for these organizations, especially if their target audience is more active on other platforms. This finding suggests that while social network marketing is generally effective, the choice of platform and the content strategy must be tailored to the specific context and objectives of the organization.

Furthermore, the study confirms a significant overall effect of social network marketing on organizational performance. This reinforces the idea that social network marketing is not merely a supplementary activity but a core strategic component that directly contributes to the overall success of service establishments. This aligns with the broader trend of digital transformation, where an organization's ability to adapt to the digital environment and adopt effective tools like social networks is crucial for its performance (Richard et al., 2009).

Conclusion:

In conclusion, this study provides empirical evidence of the positive relationship between social network marketing and organizational performance in service establishments in Guelma city. It highlights the significant reliance on social network marketing and its direct contribution to high organizational performance. The findings underscore the importance for service establishments to strategically integrate social network marketing into their overall business strategy, while also carefully considering the specific platforms and content strategies that are most effective for their context. By doing so, service establishments can leverage the power of social networks to enhance their market presence, customer engagement, and ultimately, their organizational success.

Limitations and Future Research:

Despite its contributions, this study has certain limitations. Firstly, it is a field study conducted in a specific geographical context (Guelma city), which may limit the generalizability of the findings to other regions or types of

organizations. Future research could replicate this study in different geographical areas and across various industries to assess the broader applicability of these relationships.

Secondly, the study relied on self-reported data through questionnaires, which might be subject to response bias. Future research could incorporate objective performance measures or mixed-methods approaches to provide a more comprehensive understanding.

Thirdly, the study identified a lack of correlation with YouTube. Further qualitative research could explore the specific reasons behind this, such as content strategy, audience engagement patterns, or resource allocation for YouTube marketing in service establishments.

Finally, the dynamic nature of social media platforms and marketing strategies means that the effectiveness of certain approaches can change rapidly. Longitudinal studies would be beneficial to track these changes over time and provide insights into the evolving relationship between social network marketing and organizational performance.

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